

The One-Page Margin Map

Use this before spending money on any small-business idea.
Estimates are useful; unlabeled guesses are not.

Business: _____

Date: _____

1. CUSTOMER AND JOB
Who pays, and what urgent job are they hiring the business to do?

2. REVENUE ENGINE
Price x transactions x frequency. What creates repeat purchases?

3. MARGIN ENGINE
Which two variables most strongly improve or destroy profit?

4. HIDDEN BILL
What cost is missing from the attractive version of the pitch?

SIMPLE MONTHLY MODEL

LINE	ASSUMPTION	MONTHLY ESTIMATE
Customers or transactions		
Average revenue per customer		
Gross revenue	Customers x average revenue	
Variable costs		
Fixed operating costs		
Debt, owner pay, and reserves		
Estimated cash remaining	Revenue minus all costs	

5. OPERATOR EDGE
What can a strong operator do that a weak operator will not?

6. FASTEST CHEAP TEST
What can you validate before buying equipment, signing a lease, or borrowing?

VERDICT

What must be true for this business to work, and what evidence would make you walk away?

Educational worksheet only. Verify assumptions independently. This is not financial, legal, tax, or investment advice.